Mark Scheme — Vocabulary Test 10

English Language 1123
By Miss Jaweria

Section A — Vocabulary in Context

(a) 'gradually diminished' **[2 marks]**

Award 1 mark for each bullet up to a maximum of 2 marks:

- ('gradually') slowly / bit by bit / step by step / over time / little by little
- ('diminished') decreased / reduced / got quieter / faded / lessened / weakened

Guidance: Do NOT credit "stopped" for diminished. LOOK FOR slow reduction.

(b) 'remained alert' **[2 marks]**

Award 1 mark for each bullet up to a maximum of 2 marks:

- ('remained') stayed / kept / continued to be / did not stop being
- ('alert') watchful / vigilant / attentive / on guard / ready / aware of surroundings

Guidance: Do NOT credit "awake" alone. LOOK FOR active watchfulness.

Section B — Word Choice

(c) 'perilous' rather than 'difficult' **[1 mark]**

- perilous suggests life-threatening danger / risk of death / extreme hazard // difficult just means hard; perilous implies their lives are at stake

Guidance: LOOK FOR danger to life.

(d) 'precious' rather than 'nice' **[1 mark]**

- precious suggests deep emotional value / irreplaceable / treasured / loved beyond measure // nice is too weak; precious conveys how important and irreplaceable it is to her

Guidance: LOOK FOR deep emotional attachment.

Section C — Writer's Effect

(e) 'flourish' **[2 marks]**

Award 1 mark for each idea up to a maximum of 2 marks:

- the school is growing / thriving / succeeding / doing well / blossoming
- it is improving / becoming better / achieving great success
- creates hope / optimism // the reader feels happy / hopeful / inspired

Guidance: LOOK FOR growth and success. NOT: big alone.

(f) 'widespread' **[2 marks]**

Award 1 mark for each idea up to a maximum of 2 marks:

- the damage covers a large area / is everywhere / affects many places
- it is far-reaching / impossible to escape / no place was untouched
- creates shock / horror // the reader feels overwhelmed / sad / hopeless

Guidance: LOOK FOR how far the damage reaches.

Section D — Word Bank Answers

(g) reputation — What people think of you / status
(h) foundation — Base / groundwork / starting point
(i) valuable — Worth a lot / important
(j) precious — Valuable / cherished / treasured

Distractors (unused): barren, remote

Mark Breakdown:

Section A (a-b)	4
Section B (c-d)	2
Section C (e-f)	4
Section D (g-j)	6
TOTAL	**16**